

Tanks of the Nonaligned World (cont.)

Some nations used both domestic and upgraded foreign vehicles—South Korea and Israel both moved from upgrades to indigenous vehicles as their economies developed. In addition to being a symbol of industrial and military power, a domestically-designed tank could be optimized for the conditions a country expected to face on the battlefield. The unique designs of the Israeli Merkava and Swedish Strv 103 illustrate this most clearly.



< Panzer 68

Date	1971	Country	Switzerland
Weight	45 tons (40.8 tonnes)		
Engine	MTU V8 diesel, 660 hp		
Main armament	105 mm L7 L/52 rifled gun		

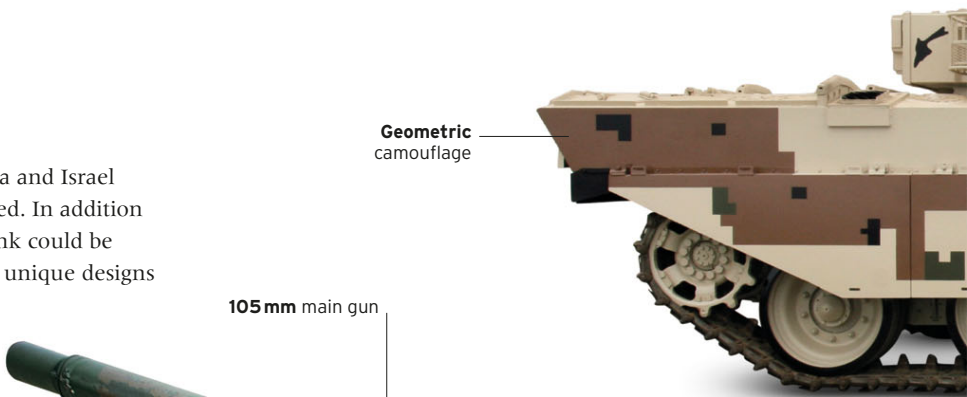
Based on the Panzer 61, the Panzer 68 featured wider tracks with rubber pads to improve mobility, especially over snow, and a gun stabilization system that enabled more accurate firing on the move. The final version, Panzer 68/88, served until the early 2000s.



△ Type 74

Date	1975	Country	Japan
Weight	41.9 tons (38 tonnes)		
Engine	Mitsubishi 10ZF diesel, 720 hp		
Main armament	105 mm L7 L/52 rifled gun		

Developed in response to the Soviet T-62, the Type 74 suffered from a long development period and slow entry into service; 893 were built, the last in 1989. Its hydropneumatic suspension could raise, lower, or incline the vehicle to suit terrain. Upgrades included a laser range finder and improved night-vision systems.



105 mm main gun



Gun sight aperture

105 mm main gun



7.62 mm machine gun

Skirt

▷ Merkava 1

Date	1979	Country	Israel
Weight	66.1 tons (59.9 tonnes)		
Engine	Continental AVDS-1790-6A diesel, 900 hp		
Main armament	105 mm M68 L/52 rifled gun		

The Merkava incorporated lessons from Israeli combat experience, meaning crew protection was highly emphasized. The engine was placed at the front and a door in the rear hull allowed protected ammunition resupply and casualty evacuation under fire. The Mark 1 was first used in Lebanon in 1982. The Mark 2 and 3 vehicles were significant redesigns; in addition, all three received further upgrades.